

Two lines of thinking emerge in this situation, each presenting two distinct questions:

- 1) Will new technology result in mass unemployment as humans lose jobs to robots?
- 2) Will robots create new career opportunities for humans?

To put it another way, are today's technical breakthroughs akin to those of the past, which rendered the employment of horse cart manufacturer obsolete while creating the job of automobile producer? Or are today's developments distinct in any fundamental - mental way? This isn't an altogether new concern. New technologies have been a source of concern in Britain since the Luddites of the 19th century, owing to the changes they bring.



A robot cook

Jeffrey Sachs and Laurence Kotlikoff, both American economists, believe that such problems are still relevant in today's world. They pose an important question:

What if machines become so intelligent that they no longer require unskilled labour to function?

They point out that smart machines are already performing tasks that were previously only performed by humans, including as collecting highway tolls, checking customers out at businesses, measuring blood pressure, offering directions, answering phones, printing documents, flying planes,